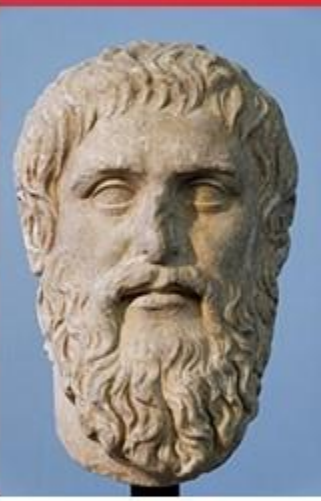
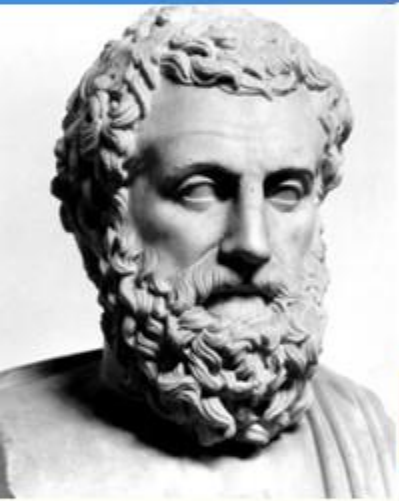


ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE



HUMAN VALUES

MODULE - 15

**LESSONS FROM THE
LIVES OF PEOPLE**

- Multifaceted and the first Asian to win the Nobel Prize, he was **not a fan of conventional education system**.
- He **valued unity** and strongly **protested the division of Bengal** on religious lines, and repudiated his Knighthood in protest against Jalianwalabag massacre.
- He was **conscious of India's culture and destiny** and used his writings to **resonate hope and national regeneration**.
- He was **against caste and religious dogmatism and insularity**.
- A great admirer of Gandhi, Tagore **didn't hesitate to differ with him on the issues of logic and reason**.
- He was a proponent of **modern technology as a means to reduce poverty**.

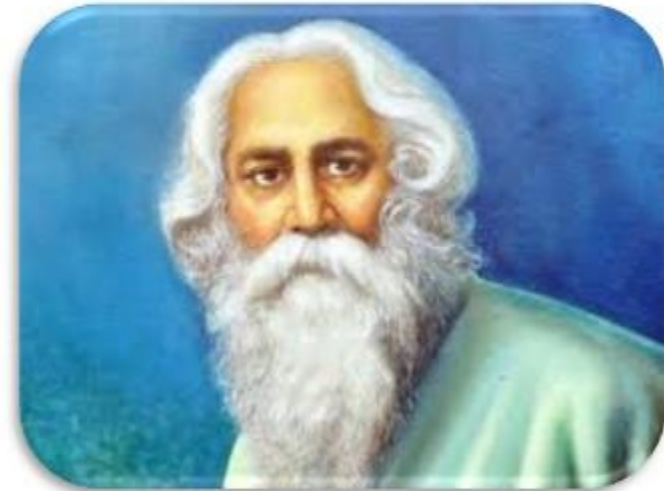
He advocated being of **service to others**, preserving **one's own dignity**, having a **broader outlook**, and steering **away from corruption** – both physical and spiritual.



“I slept and dreamt that life was joy. I awoke and saw that life was service. I acted and behold, service was joy.”

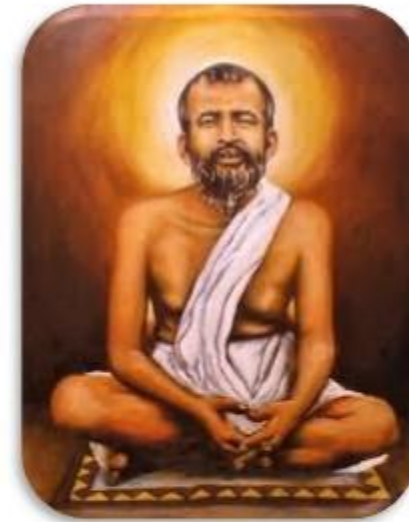
- He highly **valued education** and strived to advance education in India.
- Tagore believed that **human freedom and critical reasoning** must be the foundation of education, which is the most **important element in the economy of development of a country**.
- Although he **opposed British rule**, he was open minded enough to **acknowledge the positives** of the contributions of Poetic and liberal thinking from England.
- Some consider his **poetry** to be **abstract** and aloof from realities, but he was **a genius poet** and the only one to have the distinction of **authoring the national anthems of two countries**.

He valued: Humanism, Education, Self-Direction, Cultural Diversity, Freedom, Simplicity, Spirituality, and Nature.



“You can't cross the sea merely by standing and staring at the water.”

- A man who spends his time in discussing the good and bad qualities of others simply wastes his own time.
- Be not a traitor to your thoughts. Be sincere; act according to your thoughts; and you shall surely succeed.
- One is safe to live in the world, if one has Viveka (discrimination of the Real from the unreal), and Vairagya (dispassion), and an intense devotion to God.
- Women whether naturally good or not, whether chaste or unchaste, should always be regarded as images of the Blissful Divine Mother.
- The tree laden with fruits always bends low. If you wish to be great, be lowly and meek.



“Many good sayings are to be found in holy books, but merely reading them will not make one religious.”

- He is a true man whose **passions and propensities** have been **curbed** to extinction as in a dead body.
- **Money should be a servant of a man**, not the other way around.
- **Learn patience and endurance** from the movements of the anvil of a blacksmith.
- **Each religion** in the world shows one of the ways of reaching the God.
- It is **glorious to help even one man**.
- He alone is the **true teacher** who is **illuminated by the light of true Knowledge**.
- Rain-water never stands on high ground, but runs down to the lowest level. So also **the mercy of God remains** in the hearts of **the lowly**, but drains off from those of the vain and the proud.



“It is the mind that makes one wise or ignorant, bound or emancipated.”

- After mastering western philosophy and history, he faced a spiritual crisis in his youth and showed great resolve to find answers.
- He faced the loss of his father and Guru with fortitude, never flinching from his goal.
- He was the first Indian religious leader to identify neglect of downtrodden as the root cause of India's regression.
- He valued educating women and the poor and inspiring self-confidence in the masses.
- Diligence, discipline, self-belief and knowledge can make one succeed, as seen in tremendous reception to his speech at World's Parliament of Religions.
- His theory of ethics and principles of purity are based on the intrinsic purity and oneness of the *Atman*.



“Whatever you think, that you will be. If you think yourselves weak, weak you will be; if you think yourselves strong, strong you will be.”

- He strongly advocated **mastering science** while **retaining religious and spiritual roots**.
- He instilled **sense of duty, pride in our past** and **sense of mission**.
- Duty to the downtrodden masses, forming a definite philosophy of service and organizing social service were **valued** by him.
- He **contributions** to Indian culture and **Hinduism** are immense: Giving a clear-cut identity to Hinduism, unification of Hinduism, defending the religion and its rejuvenation and modernization.
- **Service to man is equated with service to God**. He proposed fusing God realisation with service to God in man.
- Stressed on **having correct thoughts** as they eventually manifest into reality.

He valued: Education, National integration, Nation Building, Faith, Confidence, Obedience, Social Service, Ability of Youth, Self-belief, patience, Perseverance and Love.



“Condemn none: if you can stretch out a helping hand, do so. If you cannot, fold your hands, bless your brothers, and let them go their own way.”

- Inculcate the quality of **taking on the challenge** and **embrace the change**. He showed these qualities in opposing then prevalent ill practices and reforming education.
- He believed that we are all **born equal** and are **entitled to all the rights** that the law provides, without any compromise.
- He believed that **Indians should learn** the good things **from the west** and infuse that with traditional knowledge to produce unique, potent results.
- Despite his radical views and ideas, Raja Ram Mohan Roy was **a firm believer in the omnipotent presence of God**. He stressed that there was **only one God** despite the many religions that prevailed in India.



He regarded **educational reform** as a **supplement to social reform**. He founded Vedanta College whose courses synthesized Western and Indian learning.

- A vocal **supporter for the rights of women**, he strived to abolish sati and encouraged widow remarriage.
- He did not believe that the **scriptures** were being properly read and implemented in society.
- He was a strong **supporter of the rights of the downtrodden**, a strong propagator of the concept of the **universal brotherhood** of man.
- He was a strong advocate for **using the power of the media for social good**.
- He felt that **caste system caused discord** and discontent among people of the same faith.
- We should **exercise our rights** and ensure that the rights of others are not infringed upon.



He looked **beyond** the then prevailing **circumstances** of despair and humiliation **towards a bright future** based on assimilation of Western culture and democracy.

- The **tragedy** of two deaths in the family made him **more resolved** to find the truth than be grief stricken.
- He was known for his **logical, scientific and critical analysis** of religious faiths.
- He **forgave** the cook and the dancer who **plotted to kill him** even after suffering excruciating pain.
- He believed that **caste system is iniquitous**.
- **Women are free and equals** to men and they are **entitled to honour and respect**.
- He advocated **loyalty to India's glorious heritage** and ascribed its downfall to disloyalty to that heritage.
- **Change is necessary** and it is imperative to **abandon harmful customs** and **cultivate modern outlook**.

He is considered to be a learned **Sanskrit scholar**, a **metaphysician**, a great **orator** and a fearless **denunciator of evil**.



“What is crucial in dealing with loss is not to lose the lesson. That makes you a winner in the most profound sense.”

- His concept of **social inclusion** was interpreted from ancient **Hindu scriptures**.
- He **opposed child marriages** and preached **respect** to the wise and the learned, to one's father and mother, and all chaste men and women.
- He brought about a **complete overhaul of the education system** by introducing Anglo-Vedic schools to offer students an updated curriculum, imparting both the **knowledge of the Vedas**, and contemporary **English education**.
- He brought a revolution in the **notion of divinity**.
- In spite of all of his achievements, he **never hankered after power or pelf**.



“It is not wrong to be an ignorant; it is an error to continue to be an ignorant.”

- When he was 38 years old, Aurobindo abandoned politics and dedicated his life to spiritual journey, showing that it is **never too late in life to follow what you value**.
- You need to **have a noble goal**, to reach the true heights of greatness in your life.
- Whatever you **do**, should be done **with complete mindfulness and dedication**.
- You should **maintain your mental calm** and try not to respond and react whenever things around you seem too difficult and disturbing.
- The greatest courage you can show is by **realizing your own mistake** and **admitting** it.
- Before pointing out the faults of others and getting angry with them, you should **be conscious of your own flaws**.

- A great **philosopher, patriot, scholar, social reformer** and **visionary**, he was one of the first leaders to call for full independence.
- His **writings** helped lift the morale and dispel the gloom and despondency of the subjugated nation.
- His **thoughts were broadminded and unprejudiced**, and his message of self-enlightenment based on deep internal meditation is applicable to the whole humanity.

AUROBINDO

- You need to make a constant and unrelenting effort to remain connected with the Divine power within you.
- Meditation does help us, but any service with full devotion and care can be much more fruitful in leading you closer to God.
- All good deeds are the result of a united and patient effort.
- You need to replace competition and rivalry with co-operation and brotherhood.
- Cultivate love and empathy for one and all.
- Your constant endeavour should be to overcome your shortcomings, your ignorance and your illusions.
- Your biggest triumph is in controlling your own self.



“Our actual enemy is not any force exterior to ourselves, but our own crying weaknesses, our cowardice, our selfishness, our hypocrisy, our purblind sentimentalism.”

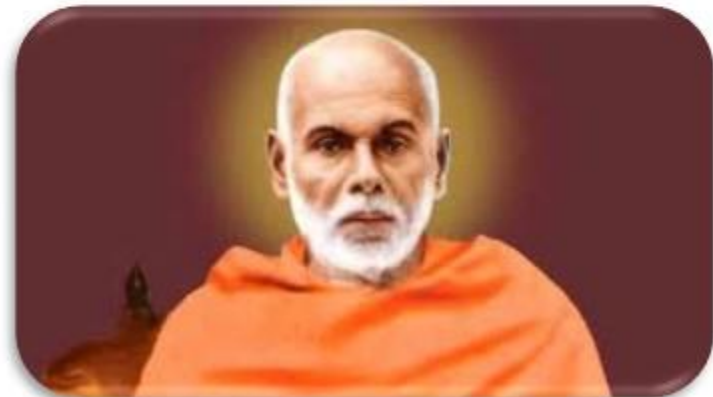
- Wrong knowledge gives rise to divisive tendency and leads to confrontations.
- People should learn that quarrel will end in destruction. One who realizes this becomes peaceful.
- All human beings, without exception desire for happiness and contentment. All that is done materially or spiritually are meant for this objective.
- Never imitate anyone or anything blindly.
- Any law should be suitably reformed as per the requirements of time.
- A hygienic way of life should be practiced as a tradition.
- In order to avoid causing unhappiness to others, our words should be conditioned to please others with truth and endearments.

HIS TEN COMMANDMENTS

- Be enlightened with education.
- Be strengthened with organization.
- Make progress through industry.
- Don't speak caste, ask caste and think caste.
- One caste, one religion and one God for mankind.
- Whatever be the religion, it is sufficient if it is good for mankind.
- Whatever be the difference in faith, dress or language, as all humanity belongs to one caste, there is no harm in inter- marriage and inter-dining.
- Do not make liquor, don't drink it and don't sell it.
- Spend judiciously.
- Man who knows dharma should work hard for the progress and well-being of his neighbour.

- All Human beings are of one species (caste), and they should live as such.
- No speaker should speak to the people on a subject that is not clear to himself.
- Religion inspires people to work for contentment. Therefore everyone's religion is the same.
- Tell truth and practice Dharma and learn lessons every day.
- Self-knowledge is the awareness which enables one to experience and see as a witness objectively all manifestations of this universe including pride and ego.
- Worshipping of God is possible only through the service of mankind.
- The purpose of a public speech is to know and to make known, not enrage others.

- Non-violence, truthfulness, non-covetousness, non-adultery and abstinence from intoxicants are summarily defined as *pancha dharma* or five cardinal principles of righteousness.
- The attractiveness, clarity, sweetness, transparency, appropriateness and harmony are the qualities of words.



- Born in a cobbler family, he had to **overcome social prejudices** to receive his due from his coreligionists.
- He told the society of that time that a **human being is recognized by his good deeds** and not by his birth or caste.
- He was not entangled and engrossed in the vagaries of human life but was ahead and **beyond the petty things of human life**.
- Believed to have mystic healing powers, he **assisted whoever approached him**.
- He preached that **God resides in the hearts** of all his devotees and performance of **rites and ceremonies** are not means to know God.
- With his **knowledge** and **perseverance**, he earned the admiration of scores of people and even royals.



- The **efforts** exerted to attain even the non-achievable will **produce** deserving **result**.
- Although laborious, **farming is the foremost activity** as the world is dependent on it.
- The **character** of men reflects **the company they keep**.
- **Friendship** is felt deep within the smiling heart.
- Men's **greatness** is **proportionate** to their **knowledge**.
- If anyone **does a wrong thing** to you, **do good** to them.
- **Think before undertaking a work**. Thinking after commencement brings disgrace.
- Whatever is aimed to be done will be **achieved** as planned **if** the planners possess **firmness in execution**.

A great poet, preacher and thinker, his fame is drawn from his work *Thirukkural*, which reflects **humane, refined and universal moral values**.



“Those who pretend to know what they don't will be thought ignorant of even what they know.”

- The more you **know yourself**, the more clarity there is. **Self-knowledge has no end** – you don't come to an achievement; you don't come to a conclusion. It is **an endless river**.
- The **mind** that adheres to the security of a **closed** box eventually **decays** into mindlessness and ill-reason.
- **Die to everything of yesterday** so that your mind is always fresh, always young, innocent, full of vigor and passion.
- If you say **harsh words** to me, it **hurts** me; but if that hurt is **not given importance**, it does not become the background from which I act; so it is possible that I **meet you afresh**. That is **real education**, in the deep sense of the word.

People all too often fall into a set way of doing things. They get too comfortable and overly complacent. They become attached to tradition. They cling to the safety and security of what they know. They lose sight of fresh insight. They fall into strict dogmatism.



“Any tradition seeking to pigeonhole truth into a box will eventually lose touch with the underlying essence of cosmic change.”

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